

FIRST LIGHT -- MASTER TRAINING PLAN 2026-2028 (v5)

0. THE ATHLETE -- what the data says (all-time Supabase pull, Aug 22)

- 135 runs / 711 km. Feb-May 2026 = DAILY runner: 31 runs/month at ~170 km/month for three straight months.
- Half marathon already done: 21.3 km on May 24, 2026 -- 2:09 at 6:05/km (HR 171, raced hard). Multiple 10-12k runs at 6:18-6:40/km.
- 18 rides / 1,518 km -- longest 170.7 km at HR 128. The bike engine is the strongest asset.
- 20 swims (since Mar), 88 walks incl. one 50.7 km.
- Gap: run frequency collapsed after June (Jul 1 run, Aug 2). Diagnosis: returning runner, ~10 weeks run-detrained, engine fully maintained -- rebuilds fast, but tendons still need the ramp respected.

Anupam Kumar · compiled Aug 22, 2026 · supersedes v1

HM Sep 27, 2026 · TMM FULL Jan 17, 2027 · Ironman 70.3 Feb 17, 2027 · -> 100 KM RUN Dec 2027 · -> FULL IRONMAN Jan 2028

The system: ONE weekly template + ONE daily clock, forever. Only the DIALS turn each month (Section 9). You never change the template -- you look up the month, read the dials, execute.

Season shape: 5 weeks run-RETURN to the HM (not a beginner build) -> 16 weeks marathon build -> TMM -> recover -> swim/bike sharpen -> 70.3. The HM is a supported training run and pacing benchmark. TMM is the A-race. The 70.3 rides TMM's run fitness.

1. THE WEEKLY TEMPLATE (FINAL -- approved Aug 22)

Day	Morning	Post-market (after 3 PM)
Mon	Swim easy 6:05-6:50 -- pure recovery after Sunday	rest
Tue	Swim 6:00-6:50 -> GYM #1 (lower + calves) 7:30-8:15	Study 3:05 -> easy RUN 4:15-5:15 -> dinner 5:30
Wed	LONG RUN 5:00-7:00 (pool closed anyway)	rest
Thu	Swim 6:00-6:50 -> GYM #2 (upper + core) 7:30-8:15	rest
Fri	Swim 6:00-6:50 -> GYM #3 (full-body LIGHT -- never heavy legs) 7:30-8:15	REST -- lights out 8:30
Sat	Swim easy 6:00-6:40 -> RIDE #1: tempo 60-90 min ~7:00-8:30	rest -- lights out 8:30
Sun	TRI DAY: short swim -> RIDE #2: LONG (glide path) -> brick run 5-10k (full 15-21k brick 1x/month)	rest

Weekly totals: swim x6 · gym x3 (Tue/Thu/Fri -- taper weeks drop to 1x) · ride x2 (Sat tempo + Sun long) · run x3 (We long, Tu easy, Su brick) · Mon = the recovery anchor.

Sunday ride glide path: Aug-Oct 100k · Nov alternate 100/70 · Dec 60k easy or less · Jan taper 40k or less · Feb 90k race-sims. Nov-Dec swap (pre-decided): the long run outgrows Wednesday (26-32k = 3h+) and takes SUNDAY morning; the ride shrinks and Wednesday becomes a moderate 60-75 min. Sunday tri day goes monthly.

Calf + soleus micro-dose (We AM + Tu PM, 15 min, home): heavy single-leg calf raises straight + bent knee + hip stability -- the #1 marathon-injury insurance.

Monsoon rule: radar the night before -- wet outskirts = swap days or track loops. Best equipment buy: indoor trainer.

Vehicle law: scooty for every hop under 5 km · racing bike touches road ONLY Sat tempo + Sun outskirts · car = carries the bike out of the city Sunday.

COOK PROTOCOL -- SMART LOCK + CAMERA (Mon-Sat 7:00-7:30ish, Sun off):

- Access: smart-lock personal code (revocable, time-stamped) + cameras at entrance and kitchen (Mi 360 2K Pro class, SD local recording) + hall Tapo/Mi 360 on 24/7 continuous SD + Mini DC UPS powering router AND camera (4-8h through any power cut) + offline-alerts ON. All rooms LOCKED -- kitchen-only access.
- Food trust = MENU CARDS: 6 cards written Sunday evening, clipped to the fridge; menu WhatsApped the night before. The cook never decides anything.
- His 7:00-7:30 fuzzy arrival is irrelevant: nothing in the morning waits for him. Breakfast is self-serve (whey + yesterday-prepped oats/poha). Dabba ready by ~9:00, desk lunch 1:30.
- The weekend solves itself: Sunday (the 6-hour tri day) is the cook's DAY OFF -- zero conflict. Saturday you are home by ~8:30, fully supervised. Sunday: self batch-cook after the ride.

Office/market law: at the computer 9:00-3:00, untouchable (office days: leave ~8:20, desk by 9:00). Evening chain fixed regardless: 7:00 rituals -> 8:45 lights out (Fri/Sat 8:30).

2. PACES -- WHAT "EASY" AND "LONG" ACTUALLY MEAN (calibrated to YOUR data)

Your benchmarks: HM 2:09 = 6:05/km at HR 171 (max effort) · best 10k ~6:18/km · historical "easy" runs 6:30-6:50 at HR 150-160 -- that was your mistake: your easy was never easy.

Zone	Pace (min/km)	HR	Feel test
EASY (all Wed/Fri runs, warmups)	7:00 - 7:30	135-145, hard cap 145	Full sentences out loud. Nose-breathing possible. Feels embarrassingly slow -- THAT IS CORRECT
LONG RUN (Sunday)	7:00 - 7:30 same as easy	cap 150	Distance is the workout, never pace. Walk 60 sec every 5 km -- legal, smart, ultra-prep
Marathon pace (MP)	6:10 - 6:20	155-162	Comfortably strong. Only in Tue workouts + noted long-run finishes
HM effort	5:55 - 6:10	160-168	Race gear. Tue intervals only

Zone	Pace (min/km)	HR	Feel test
Strides	fast-relaxed 20 sec	n/a	4 x 20s after easy runs, walk-back recovery. Speed without cost

The rule that governs everything: HR beats pace, pace beats feel. If HR drifts over the cap -- slow down or walk. The watch decides, not the ego. 80% of your weekly km live in the EASY row; that is where endurance is actually built.

HOW EACH SESSION RUNS:

- Easy run: out the door, 7:00-7:30/km, HR alarm at 145. If it beeps -- walk 60s. No exceptions, no "feeling good today".
- Long run (Sunday): easy pace + this month's distance dial. Fuel 30-60 g carbs/h once past 90 min. Walk breaks every 5 km. Lift to MP for the final 3-4 km ONLY when the dial table says so.
- Tue quality: 10 min easy warmup -> the prescribed workout -> 10 min easy cooldown. This is the ONLY hard run of the week.
- Sat ride: steady endurance, HR 125-140 (your 170k ride averaged 128 -- that is the model).

2b. THE DAILY CLOCK (never changes)

Time	Block
3:30	Wake -- rituals (collagen 3:40, salt-water 3:42)
3:45 - 4:05	Brahma Muhurta -- meditation + japa
4:05	Coffee + L-theanine (only caffeine of the day)
4:15 - 5:45	STUDY 1+2 -- 90 min deep block (Wed: 40 min, long run rolls 5:00)
5:40	Oats + creatine (pre-train)
6:00 - 6:50	SWIM -- in the water 6:00 SHARP, daily except Wednesday -> home ~7:00
7:15	Breakfast -- self-serve, never waits for the cook
7:30 - 8:15	GYM on Tue/Thu/Fri · STUDY 2 (60 min) on Mon/Wed/Sat
8:50	Desk ready -> 9:00 - 3:00 MARKET (lunch 1:30 at the desk)
3:05 - 3:45	STUDY 3 (40 min) -> 2h30 study daily
4:15 - 5:15	Tue only: easy run -> recovery dinner 5:30
5:00 - 5:30	Fuel top-up (big days; SAT = double)
7:00	PHONE POWER OFF -> drawer (ON 9:00 AM; watch eSIM = emergency line) · day logged 6:40-6:55 · evening rituals · 7:52 milk + paneer
8:45	LIGHTS OUT (Fri + Sat: 8:30)

SUNDAY TRI-DAY SOP: wake 3:30 -> rituals + Study 1 -> short swim 6:00-6:30 -> car out (bike loaded Saturday eve) -> oats jar + banana in the car -> long ride per glide path, 60 g carbs/h -> brick run 5-10k straight off the bike -> recovery shake -> home ~12:15 -> big self-lunch -> afternoon full rest -> early night. Cook is off Sunday -- the day is completely yours.

3. PHASE 1 -- HALF MARATHON BUILD (Aug 24 - Sep 27)

Calibrated to a returning 2:09-HM runner -- no walk-runs, real volume from week 1, tendon-respecting ramp (~30 -> 36 km/wk):

Week of	Tue run	Wed run	Fri run	Sun LONG RUN*	Sun ride
Aug 24	40 min easy + 4 strides	30 min easy	40 min easy	Aug 30 -- 12 km	100k
Aug 31	45 min w/ 3 x 6 min @ HM effort	35 min easy	40 min easy	Sep 6 -- 14 km	100k
Sep 7	45 min w/ 2 x 10 min @ HM effort	35 min easy	40 min easy	Sep 13 -- 16 km, last 4 @ HM effort	100k
Sep 14	40 min w/ 2 x 8 min @ HM effort	30 min easy	30 min easy	Sep 20 -- 10 km easy	70k
Sep 21	30 min + strides	20 min jog	20 min shakeout	RACE Sep 27	Sep 26: 20 min spin ONLY

Phase-1 note: until the Nov swap, the LONG RUN column executes on WEDNESDAY 5 AM and the ride column on SUNDAY (tri day). Sunday also carries the brick run.

RACE TARGETS (data-derived): May's 2:09 was run at HR 171 -- max effort on daily-5k fitness. This time: race at HR cap ~158-160, 6:10-6:15/km through 15 km, then close hard. A-goal: sub-2:05 · B-goal: 2:10 feeling controlled. Beating 2:09 at 10+ beats lower HR = proof the engine grew. Record avg HR + the km where it got hard -- that sets TMM pacing. Boxing does NOT start until October.

SAFETY VALVE (pre-decided): any bone or tendon pain in weeks 1-3 -> the Sep 27 HM becomes a 10k, no negotiation. The season is Jan 17. (The engine survived the layoff -- tendons are the only thing that didn't. They adapt on their own schedule regardless of fitness.)

4. PHASE 2 -- MARATHON BUILD (Sep 28 - Jan 17)

Every 4th Sunday = down week: track brick replaces the long run, and the Monday of every down week is a FULL rest day -- the only full rest in the cycle, taken even when feeling great.

Month	Sun long runs	Tue quality	Sat ride	Notes
Oct	14 -> 16 -> 18 -> down (track brick)	20-30 min tempo	100k	Gut training starts: 30-60 g carbs/h every Sunday over 90 min. Boxing begins (Fri, bag only)
Nov	20 -> 22 -> 24 -> down	2 x 15 min @ marathon pace	alternate 100k / 70k	One HM-distance rehearsal inside a long run
Dec	26 -> 28 -> 30-32 (by ~Dec 20) -> down	3 x 15 min @ MP	60k easy or less	PEAK. Final 3 long runs = full race-day rehearsal (3:30 wake, oats, kit, fueling)
Jan	Jan 3: 20 km w/ MP finish -> Jan 10: 12 km -> Jan 17: TMM	short + strides	40k -> 30k -> Jan 16: REST	3-week taper. Trust it

TMM TARGET (provisional, locked after Sep 27): a 2:05-2:09 HM projects a 4:20-4:35 full off a proper 16-week build (peak long run 30-32k, peak week ~50-55 km). Decide the exact number from the HM result.

70.3 TARGET (provisional): swim ~45-50 min · bike 3:15-3:30 (the 170k-ride engine is the weapon -- but hold back to save the run) · run 2:15-2:25 -> ~6:30-7:00 finish.

TMM race week: Thu-Sat carb-load (double-carb lunches, daily 5 PM top-up, race-eve 5:30 dinner heavy on rice; night still milk + paneer). Race morning = the normal 3:30 wake, big oats 3 h before the ~5:25 start, 45-60 g carbs/h from km 5.

5. PHASE 3 -- IRONMAN 70.3 BLOCK (Jan 18 - Feb 17)

Weeks	Focus
Jan 18-31	RECOVER. Easy swims, easy spins, walks. No running until ~Jan 27, then 20-30 min easy
Feb 1-14	SHARPEN. Swim to 2-2.2 km continuous + race-pace 100s (Mon/Tue/Thu/Sat). Sat = 90k race-simulation at target effort + 20 min brick run. Sun = track brick. 2-3 race-ORDER sims (swim first, drive = T1 practice) + 2-3 OPEN-WATER swims -- the 70.3 swim has no walls; sighting drills every 4th length from January. One 15 km run Feb 8
Feb 15-17	Mini-taper: short swim + 30 min spin + strides. RACE Feb 17. Pace the bike conservatively -- the run is in the legs from TMM

6. NUTRITION FRAME

- Oats pre-train · whey + carbs within 30 min post-train · LUNCH = biggest meal (salad + dal first, roti last, millet > white rice) · nuts 3:35 · 5 PM top-up on big days · night = milk + paneer only (30 g casein).
- Protein 1.8-2.0 g/kg/day in 4 feedings. Creatine 5 g EVERY day. B12 daily. Caffeine curfew 2 PM.
- Never run long fasted. Saturday ride: fueled from km 0, bottles mixed Friday night. Saturday = highest-carb day of the week. No weight-cutting during the build. Weekly Sunday weight check -- unintended downward drift = eat more, not train less.
- Blood panel every 6 months: B12+MMA, ferritin, 25-OH-D, HbA1c, testosterone, T3, LFT.

7b. THE PRIORITY LADDER -- what survives when a day breaks

Order in the day is engineering (skip-risk); THIS ladder is priority. Pre-decided -- never negotiate at 6 AM:

1. SLEEP 8:45 -- the engine for both goals
2. STUDY 1 at 4:15 -- study's guaranteed seat, every day, nothing can take it
3. The day's training (5:00-7:00) -- covenant
4. STUDY 2 + 3 -- the suspension: on a broken day they slide to the 9:45 block or drop WITHOUT guilt
5. Everything else

A broken day containing sleep + 40 min study + the workout is a SUCCESSFUL day.

Study math: 2h10 x ~350 days = 750+ hours/year -- 3-4 certifications' worth, alongside the Ironman build. Both goals are funded; neither is second.

Study season dial: exam/certification push -> Mon + Thu 5-6 slots (mobility) convert to study = 3h30 those days, zero damage to runs/swims/races. Exam week = training drops to maintenance (a taper in reverse). Seasons, not daily warfare.

Block assignment: 4:15 = hardest NEW material (freshest brain) · 7:50 = practice/problems (post-exercise learning window) · 9:00 = review/notes (consolidation).

8. THE LAWS (final)

1. The daily clock never changes. Study 4:15, train 6:00, lights out 8:45 -- the plan lives inside the day.
2. The Big Four are covenant-grade: Sunday long run · Saturday 100k · two quality swims · 8:45-3:30 sleep. Everything else is garnish -- droppable guilt-free on a bad week.
3. Easy means easy -- HR at or below 140-145 on every run that isn't Tuesday. 80/20 polarization is the engine.
4. Thursday stays a single session and every 4th week is a down week -- even when feeling great. Especially then.
5. Sleep is the circuit breaker: under 6 h in bed = the day's second session is cancelled automatically. Morning resting HR +7 bpm over baseline = same rule.
6. 100k in 3.5 h is the December target, not the day-1 target. Start at 4 h; speed comes from the weeks.
7. Fix the HAE sleep sync -- the system's most important sensor has been blind since Jul 23.
8. Calf micro-dose Tue + Fri is non-negotiable through the entire run ramp -- it is the injury gatekeeper.
9. Monsoon rule: Friday-night radar decides the weekend shape. Never ride the outskirts in rain.
10. Any bone/tendon pain -> drop to the pre-decided fallback (HM->10k; a missed week costs nothing, a stress fracture costs the season).

9. THE 18-MONTH DIAL TABLE -- look up the month, turn the dials, never touch the template

Template stays: Mo swim+gym · Tu quality run->swim+calf · We easy run · Th swim only · Fr easy run+box+calf · Sa = LONG-ENDURANCE #1 (dial: ride or run) · Su = LONG-ENDURANCE #2 (dial: long-run km) · 4th week = down + Mon rest.

Month	Sun LONG RUN dial	Weekend ride dial	Tue quality dial	Swim dial	~Run km/wk	Focus
Aug 2026	12 km	ride 100k	40 min easy + strides	3x/wk	30	HM return
Sep 2026	14 -> 16 -> 10 -> HM Sep 27	100k -> 70k -> 20-min spin	HM efforts 3x6 -> 2x10 min	hold	32-36	RACE: HM (A sub-2:05)
Oct 2026	14 -> 16 -> 18	ride 100k	tempo 20-30 min	hold	35-40	TMM base · boxing starts
Nov 2026	20 -> 22 -> 24	ride 100k / 70k alt	MP 2x15 min	hold	40-48	TMM build · HM rehearsal in a long run
Dec 2026	26 -> 28 -> 30-32	ride ≤60k easy	MP 3x15 min	hold	48-55	TMM PEAK · race-day rehearsals

Month	Sun LONG RUN dial	Weekend ride dial	Tue quality dial	Swim dial	~Run km/wk	Focus
Jan 2027	20 -> 12 -> TMM Jan 17 -> recover	≤40k -> REST	strides only	technique	taper	RACE: TMM (4:20-4:35)
Feb 2027	brick runs only	90k race-sims	--	2-2.2k + open water	low	RACE: 70.3 Feb 17 (~6:30-7:00)
Mar 2027	OFF-SEASON -- 2 wks fully off, then whatever feels fun	fun rides	none	easy	0-20	MANDATORY recharge. Skipping this breaks the year
Apr 2027	12 -> 16	ride 60-80k	strides	2k	25-35	re-entry, all easy
May 2027	16 -> 20	ride 80-100k	tempo returns	2-2.5k	35-45	aerobic base
Jun 2027	18 -> 22 · optional B-race HM	ride 100k	MP blocks	2.5k	45-50	test fitness: sub-2:00 HM attempt
Jul 2027	20 -> 24 (monsoon: trainer + track)	trainer 2-3 h	hill repeats	2.5-3k	45-50	durability
Aug 2027	24 -> 26	ride 100k	tempo	3k	50-55	ultra base opens
Sep 2027	28 -> 32 · 1st back-to-back wknd: Sat 15-20 km RUN + Sun long	ride 100k (3 wks) / B2B run (1 wk)	MP	3k	55-65	ultra build 1
Oct 2027	34 -> 38 · B2B 1x/month	ride 120-140k (IM engine)	easy only	3-3.5k	60-70	ultra build 2 + IM bike grows
Nov 2027	40 -> 45 · B2B 2x/month (Sat 20-25 km run)	ride 140-160k on non-B2B wknds	easy only	3.5k	70-80	ULTRA PEAK + IM bike peak. Gut training every Sunday
Dec 2027	2-wk taper -> 100 KM RUN (mid-Dec) -> full recovery	short spins	--	easy	--	RACE: 100k -- FINISH MODE: run-walk from km 0 (run 9 min / walk 1), never race it. The IM is 5 weeks away
Jan 2028	10-14 d recovery -> 2 ride-sims 150-170k + bricks -> taper -> FULL IRONMAN	ride sims	--	3.8k open-water x2	--	RACE: IM -- swim steady, bike HR ≤135, run starts at walk-run and earns its pace

The honest line on Dec 2027 -> Jan 2028: a 100 km run five weeks before a full Ironman only works if the 100k is completed, not raced -- run-walk throughout, finish with something left. Pre-decide it now, in writing, while the ego

is calm. The run fitness transfers to the IM marathon; the recovery debt is the only thing that can break it.